



RON ACETO TEACHING PORTFOLIO RESOURCE

Responsible AI Use in Coding Rubric

Student-safe routines for debugging, coding questions, and responsible AI-supported programming.

Designed for practical classroom use with student-safe language, clear routines, and standards-aware planning notes.

AI + Coding Starter Kit | Updated June 2026

Responsible AI Use in Coding Rubric

Standards review note (June 2026): Tennessee Computer Science Foundations course standards (C10H11) remain published by the Tennessee Department of Education as May 2023 standards. Standards references in this resource are intended as cautious instructional alignment notes; final alignment should be confirmed against local district pacing, course placement, and current district guidance.

AI + Coding Starter Kit | Ron Aceto | Teaching Portfolio Resource

Ron Aceto | Page 1

programming.

Ron Aceto | Page 2

Ron Aceto | Teaching Portfolio Resource

Responsible AI Use in Coding Rubric

Responsible AI Use in Coding Rubric

AI + Coding Starter Kit | Assessment Tool | Teachers / Students

Purpose: Use the rubric with a code artifact, bug log, short reflection, or student conference.

Category

1 - Needs Support

2 - Developing

3 - Proficient

4 - Strong

Student Ownership

Student cannot explain

code or AI use.

Student explains some

code, but relies heavily

on AI output.

Student explains most code and identifies AI support.

Student clearly

Ron Aceto | Page 3

explains code, choices,

AI support, and final decisions.

Debugging Process

No clear

troubleshooting process.

Some attempt to identify or fix the issue.

Uses a basic debug process and tests the result.

Clearly identifies, isolates, fixes, verifies,

and documents the issue.

Prompt Quality

Prompt asks AI to complete the task.

Prompt asks for broad help with limited student control.

**Prompt asks for
explanation, hint, or**

Ron Aceto | Teaching Portfolio Resource

debugging support.

Prompt is specific,
ethical,

Ron Aceto | Page 4

**learning-focused, and
keeps student thinking
central.**

Code Understanding

**Student cannot
describe program
behavior.**

**Student describes
parts of the program
with gaps.**

**Student explains main
program behavior and
fix.**

**Student explains
program flow, bug
cause, fix, and possible
next improvement.**

Verification

**No testing or checking
is shown.**

Limited testing or

unclear verification.

Student tests or traces

code after revision.

Student verifies the fix

and explains how the

result was confirmed.

Ron Aceto | Page 5

Academic Integrity

AI appears to replace

student work.

AI use is unclear or

weakly documented.

AI use is documented

and generally

appropriate.

AI use is transparent,

appropriate, and

clearly supports

learning.

Teacher Notes

- Use the rubric with a code artifact, bug log, short reflection, or student conference.
- A working program should not receive full credit if the student cannot explain the code.
- AI use should be evaluated by purpose, transparency, and evidence of learning, not simply by whether AI was used.

Ron Aceto | Teaching Portfolio Resource

Student AI Use Documentation

- Students can complete these statements when submitting AI-supported coding

work

- The coding problem I worked on was: _____
- The part I tried before using AI was: _____

B**AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code****1**

- The AI prompt I used was: _____

AI helped me understand: _____

- The final code change I made was: _____

Ron Aceto | Page 6

I verified the code by: _____

Conference Questions

What does this program do?

Where was the bug or challenge?

How did you decide what to change?

What did AI explain, and what did you still do yourself?

Could you solve a similar problem without AI next time?

B**AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code****2****Detailed Tennessee Standards Connection**

This rubric supports standards when students document debugging, explain programming decisions, verify results, and evaluate whether AI use was ethical and learning-focused.

Standards source: Tennessee Department of Education, Computer Science Foundations (C10H11), May 2023. Confirm final alignment against local district pacing, approved course placement, and teacher directions.

This resource may support the following Tennessee standards when used as part of AI literacy, computer science, programming, digital ethics, or cybersecurity instruction

- CSF 9.2 - Troubleshooting Process: Students use a structured process to identify a problem, gather information, isolate causes, test a solution, verify the result, and document what they learned.

- CSF 13.1 - Social, Legal, and Ethical Issues: Students identify responsibilities related to ethical technology use, academic integrity, copyright, appropriate AI use, and responsible programming support.

- CSF 16.1 - Programming Language: Students explore programming languages such as Python and explain how programmers use them to solve a variety of IT problems.

- CSF 16.2 - Software Development Life Cycle: Students connect planning, coding, testing, refinement, deployment, and maintenance to an iterative software-development process.

Ron Aceto | Page 7

Purpose

Use this rubric to evaluate student coding work when AI support is allowed. The goal is to assess both programming understanding and responsible AI use.

Rubric

Cautious guidance: Alignment depends on local district pacing, approved course placement, teacher directions, and how the resource is used as part of instruction.

B

Ron Aceto | Teaching Portfolio Resource

AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code

3

B

AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code

4

B

AI should help students code better, not avoid learning code

4

Standards Review Standards review note (June 2026): Tennessee Computer Science Foundations course

standards

(C10H11) remain published by the Tennessee Department of Education as May 2023 standards. Standards

references in

this resource are intended as cautious instructional alignment notes; final alignment should be confirmed

against local

district pacing, course placement, and current district guidance.

Accessibility and Use

This PDF uses selectable text, a single-column reading order, high-contrast colors, consistent headings, and generous spacing to support desktop, tablet, and mobile viewing.

Accessibility and Use

This PDF uses selectable text, a single-column reading order, high-contrast colors, consistent headings, and generous spacing to support desktop, tablet, and mobile viewing.